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by JazzKat1213

Summary

The first "proper" ball post-war means that Catra's been thinking about Princess Prom. She'll try and make it up to Frosta (eventually), but she's going to make it up to her girlfriend first. Priorities and all that.

Notes

I think about the Princess Prom dip every fucking day.
I believe in suit Catra supremacy. Future Vision Catra >>> Suit Catra >>> Season 4 Catra - that is my take.
This has been living in my head for so damn long.

See the end of the work for more notes

There shouldn't be music coming from the other side of her bedroom door. Adora doesn't even know how there is, she doesn't have anything that *can* play music in her room. Realistically she knows it's probably Catra's doing. She's certain of it when she actually opens the door and Melog is right there, sat up and glowing happy blue.
And then she completely forgets about Melog and the small sound system perched near them on the vanity table, because Catra is standing by the bed in a suit. In *the* suit. Her mouth goes dry the same moment she becomes incredibly confused. Catra's smirking but she's got a nervous arm around herself; it's mixed messages.

She asks gently as she can, "What's this?"
Catra shrugs, "An apology, I guess. For ruining your first big dance."
She gets the warm melting feeling in her chest - she always does when Catra does something genuinely sweet like this, as *rare* as that is. It has only been two months since Prime, there's not been that many opportunities amongst reparations for romantic gestures, though they've been trying.
She crosses the room, Catra's still warily awaiting her reaction, but if she thinks it'll be bad, she's stupid. She puts a hand on Catra's cheek, smiling at her as she watches the tension drain. "Isn't Frosta the one you should be making this up to?"
"Yes, and I will, it's on the list. But..." Catra lets her own arm go, the nerves on her face sinking away as she whispers, "I like you more."
"I would hope so."
Catra puts her hands on her hips and she can't help relaxing into the warmth. "And I wanted to do this for you before next week."

Right. Glimmer's big peacetime celebration. They've had smaller ones, which were mostly just drinking and playing games with friends. She's learnt that Catra gets all blushy and *openly* touchy when she's drinking; no false excuses for anything. Scorpia and Bow had adored it (most people had, it was *adorable*.) They work well together - she gets just as touchy, but she also starts running her mouth when she's *not* giggling. Once, Catra let her rant about

how gorgeous she is for minutes before mumbling, *"My girlfriend is so pretty."* And proceeded to purr as she watched her dissolve into a speechless flustered state.
Their first time properly drinking together led to Catra winning an arm wrestling match against her for the first time - it is brought up far more than it has any right to be, but Adora can deal with it when it's Catra. She knows Sea Hawk was distraught, and demanded his own rematch with her to prove a point. But Catra got to her first, she remembers her climbing over the table and into her lap. She definitely remembers Catra dragging her into a bruising victory kiss, pulling back only to say;
"You're so sexy when you're losing to me."
Any annoyance promptly died at that. And stayed dead as Catra kept kissing her. There were drunken cheers from their friends. It was the first time Catra had kissed her in front of anyone.

Whether anyone's going to get that drunk at this party remains to be seen. But if Catra wants to drink enough to the point where she's okay kissing her in front of people and *in this suit* she will be ecstatic, no matter the scene they cause. The embarrassment will be worth it because *fuck* does she look good. *I know we haven't had sex yet but we agreed we were close to it and close could be right now* kind of good. Even if Catra isn't comfortable kissing her at the party, she will be kissing Catra in this suit *today*.
But first, "Well now I feel a little underdressed." Though maybe that's not so bad, she knows Catra loves it when she's got her jacket off and hair down. "Okay, wait hold on -"

She mourns to herself the loss of Catra's hands on her, so she makes it quick. Catra's clearly confused at her taking off her shoes and socks but it's just so they're equal. Catra snorts as she watches her take off her jacket.
"What are you doing?"
She lets her hair come down last, drawing it over one shoulder in what's practically an invitation. "You dressed up for me, and I know you like me like this."
Catra's got her hip cocked and for all her bravado, she's looking at her neck like she meant for her to. "Dork. Stop being so cute and get over here."

She obeys quickly, needing to be close to her while she's got this satisfied air about her. She drapes her arms over Catra's shoulders, saying teasingly, "You do get that *all of this* is incredibly cute of you."
Catra's tail fluffs up behind her. "Shut up."
"And just so *sweet*. I love it."
Catra doesn't growl in fake protest like she's expecting her to when she kisses her. But she takes charge of it so swiftly she loses her breath. She kisses her harder to stop the, *"You're so predictable,"* she thinks is coming. Catra's purr moves with her breath, she knows it can't properly break through when she's got her tongue in her mouth but she wants it so badly. She wants the proof that Catra's as happy right now as she is.

She trails her hands from around Catra's shoulders and down her chest, feeling her grin against her mouth. She thinks Catra's hands moving under her shirt are in retaliation but she doesn't really care what the *reasons* for her hands on her bare skin are. She undoes the first of Catra's buttons while still kissing her. Catra hums in amusement in a way that frustrates her as much it turns her on. She moves to kiss along Catra's jaw so that her purr can roll under her hands. A second button comes undone when she kisses under Catra's chin, a place she is well aware that her girlfriend loves. She puts her hand on Catra's sternum after the third button, petting along the fine fur there as she stands up to kiss her properly again. Catra slides her hands further up her back and Adora mirrors it on Catra's body. Catra's not wearing a bra because of course she isn't.

She shouldn't be surprised and yet, "You're trying to kill me, aren't you?"
"Bonus, really. You can touch me, Princess, I know you want to."
She sighs happily against her cheek as she takes a handful of her chest. Catra purrs into her jaw, pulling their hips flush. Part of Adora still can't fully grasp that this is something she gets to do now, that Catra wants it. Kissing she got used to quickly, entirely because she asked for kisses whenever she remembered she could, which was pretty much any time she looked at her girlfriend. Shirtless (*purring*) Catra leaves her speechless still. She

can deal with it when Catra preens the way she does at reducing her to a mess.

Anyone who's met Catra wouldn't describe her as soft, and considering the claws resting on her back maybe she shouldn't either, but Catra *is*. With her. Not all of the time. But moments like this, soft is all she's ever been. The swell of her chest and the texture of her skin and fur, even her lips; none of this is new. It feels like it every time. Catra isn't as loud as her when the situation is reversed, she just purrs, hums, sighs. Catra does the last when she winds one hand into the hairs at the base of her neck. It makes her heart beat faster, makes She-Ra come closer. Maybe her eyes are glowing, it wouldn't matter - it's reassuring knowing it doesn't make Catra panic anymore.

Adora trails another set of kisses down Catra's neck, down her chest, fully intent on following the path she's setting as far down as Catra will let her. Catra's looking at her with flushed cheeks whenever she glances up. She has no intention of stopping her descent but Catra tugs her up with a hand on her jaw. It's an ending. She pouts knowing that.
"Adora, I didn't do all this just so you could make out with me in a suit."
She adores how un-put-together Catra looks, loves being the cause of it. She squeezes the hand still on Catra's chest, delighting in how Catra obviously holds herself back from pushing into it.
"You didn't? Because this on its own is a great apology."
Catra catches her wrist in her hand and pulls it away. "No."

She drops her hands down to her sides, whispering, "Then why did you do it?"
"I - Maybe - and I mean *maybe* - I just wanted to dance with you."
Adora melts entirely. Catra's ears are down the way they always are when she does anything vulnerable, claws flex against Adora's skin and it allows her to move again. She takes Catra's face in both her hands this time, (not exactly) sneaking another look at what of her chest is exposed before fixing on her eyes.
"I love you. I would love to dance with you. But also I *am* going

to make out with you in this suit more. I will. You can't stop me."
Catra bats her with her tail but she can feel and hear how she's purring. "Think you want to do a bit more than that."
She *does*, but Catra shouldn't just *say* that. She was about to get on her knees for her - which is new, and she'll probably overthink it later.
"Oh I definitely do. But later."
"Later," Catra agrees.

"So what do we do now?"
Catra starts buttoning her shirt back up and she pouts at the loss, even though she knows it is needed for her to be able to think clearly. "Put a hand on my shoulder and give me the other one," Catra says when she's done.
She gets into the hold, glad that Catra's leading them like last time. "Full warning, I can't remember that dance for the life of me."
Catra huffs, "Well I'd like to think there are *some* things you remember."

There are. Most of it with startling clarity. Catra probably doesn't specifically mean when she dipped her and had her pressed against her thigh but - no, that smirk, that's definitely what she meant. She's accepted just how easily Catra can make her blush these past few months, but it's still a little embarrassing. The feeling - like now - is easily diffused by the way Catra looks at her, though.
"Well I mean - yeah, there's *some* things, but the actual steps are long gone."
Catra smiles at her, no longer dark and heavy, as she leads her into the first steps. "It's not the same dance, I'm not handing you off to anyone else. You're all mine now."
She loves hearing that. "Did you get jealous?"
"Of course I did."
"I did too. Wanted to be on your arm instead of Scorpia - didn't understand why yet though."

And Catra just smiles at her as she leads them around the room. Adora's glad she took her shoes off actually, with how many times

she almost steps on Catra's feet. It's simple, really. But just stepping in time with her, alone and close with her in the fading daylight is making her heart ache. If it wouldn't mean them stopping, she'd throw her arms around her and just hold her for a while.
Instead she settles for looking into the softness of her eyes and saying, "Still can't believe you're secretly a romantic."
Adora's expecting rebuttal of some kind, but Catra looks out the window, not scoffing in the way Adora knows is instinctual for her. Her claws prick into her hand and waist but she doesn't care at all when Catra's blushing like that. And then eyes snap back, "Tell anyone and all kisses while I'm wearing this suit are off the table. Or any suit for that matter."
She's not denying it. That's progress. Adora smiles like she always does when she realises, but teases back because it's safe to do, "So *mean*."

Catra pulls her in closer, the music slows down and Catra just sways with her and it's fucking perfect. Catra kisses her, it's fleeting like she thinks they'll get carried away again. (Which is fair.) Adora sighs, finally looking away from Catra and to the room. "Where'd Melog go?"
"Balcony. You know they get scarce when things get hot and heavy."
"Remind me to apologise later."
Catra hums before fitting her head to the crook of Adora's neck. They're still rocking gently in time with the music that she's mostly forgotten about, but the hold has just turned into an embrace. It's still astonishing that they can do this now, that Catra lets her have it and *wants* it.

Catra rubs her cheek against her, scent marking not obvious but not subtle either. Adora squeezes her, always wanting her to know it's okay to do. Then Catra asks quietly, "What are you thinking about?"
That's easy. "You. What else?"
"Hm. Anything in particular?"
"...Mostly the suit. Have you had this the whole time?"
Catra moves away, returning to the hold from before and starting

up the steps again with a laugh. “No, I asked the tailors to make me a replica for the party the moment Glimmer started planning, and *then* I just happened to realise as soon as it was done that our friends probably associate a bad memory with that outfit and requested another.”
Adora pushes away, far enough that her hold on Catra’s hand is the only thing touching her, their arms straight between them. Gods, she really does look devastating. It’s to make a point but she hates the distance.

“There’s another suit?”
Catra laughs, that beautifully open squeaking one and tugs them back together by their hands. “Yes.”
“Can I see this before the party?”
She’s too eager, and Catra smiles a little sadistically. “Nope. But you can see the dress I ordered for you when it’s done because I *know* that red one is the only one you own.”
“You managed to order two suits and a dress while most of the Kingdom is doing the exact same thing?”
“I am not above saying it’s for She-Ra, saviour of everyone’s asses, to get you nice things.”
Adora can’t help snorting. “You’re unbelievable.”
Their movements get a little unsteady and Adora’s sure it’s her fault until Catra tells her with clear nerves, “The dress is pretty much the same as your other one, just a different colour. I took your one with me when I ordered. I mean the top is different and it’s going to be longer but…”
Adora cuts her off with a kiss - two kisses because she can’t help herself - “Catra, I love that you’ve done all this okay. You don’t need excuses.”
“Still working on that.”

Hiding vulnerability and wanting behind false excuses is something they both struggle with, though Adora’s years with the Rebellion mean she’s not anywhere close to how she was back in the Horde. But Catra’s still there, though changing fast with their relationship. Adora knows after their first night in this room together that it means a lot to her that she’s not alone with things like this. No one else here gets it. No one outside of *them* gets

most of it, really.
“I know. Me too.”
Catra marks her jaw with her cheek quickly, and she makes sure to kiss Catra’s ear as she does it just to fluster her more.

The music changes and Catra lets go of their immediate hold, and instead wraps her arms around her waist, picks her up and spins her. Adora can’t stop her smile, her blush, or her laugh. And she doesn’t care. She didn’t know she loved being picked up until Catra started doing it, and it still doesn’t happen all that often, but Adora can’t help smiling when she does. Catra sets her down but keeps both her arms around her waist and just sways with her again. Adora buries her head into Catra’s shoulder with her arms around her neck.
“I really like dancing with you.”
Catra nuzzles into her hair, still purring, “Yeah, me too. You better save me a dance next week.”
“You can have all of them if you want.”

End Notes

Adora's dress is the same as the one from chapter 43 of You Should See Me In A Crown. Catra's suit however is this one from Strictly Come Dancing because I think about her wearing it about once a fortnight. (Embellished suits are god tier and I want ten.) She's just wearing a gold shirt underneath, though.

I have an outline for a fic where they talk about the physical part of their relationship but I don't know if I'll ever write it. But because it's not written, for context: it takes them like two months to get to second base. And they have sex for the first time like a day or two after the dance.

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